

pseudonym and to seal the record. This application sought to conceal Defendant's identity in a wrongful-death action brought by Plaintiffs Randy Montesano, et al., arising from the death of a 106-year-old woman, Lena Montesano, allegedly occurring while she was under Defendant's care.

The Court previously denied Defendant's identical request on May 12, 2026, following full briefing and opposition from Plaintiffs. That Order found no good cause existed for proceeding anonymously, noting that California's "Safe at Home" program protects the residential address and location of protected parties, not their identities in civil tort litigation.

Defendant filed the instant Motion reasserting the same arguments previously rejected by this Court. Plaintiffs again opposed. On June 11, 2026, the Court issued its Order Denying the Ex Parte Application, disposing of the matter on the merits.

Analysis

Defendant's present Motion is procedurally improper and substantively without merit.

First, the Motion is **moot**. This Court has twice ruled on this precise issue. The doctrine of law of the case bars relitigation of questions expressly decided in prior orders. Defendant's repeated filings constitute an improper attempt to circumvent the Court's prior rulings through serial motions. The Court will not entertain successive motions for identical relief.

Second, Defendant's "Objection" to the Court's June 11, 2026 Order is procedurally improper and has not been considered by the Court. Litigants may not object to interlocutory orders; appropriate appellate remedies exist for parties aggrieved by adverse rulings.

The Court notes that Defendant appears *pro se*. While the Court affords latitude to self-represented parties, Defendant is hereby placed on notice that she will be held to the same standards of compliance with the Code of Civil Procedure, Rules of Court, and Local Rules as attorneys admitted to practice before this Court. The Court expects strict adherence to procedural requirements governing motion practice. Failure to comply with these standards may result in sanctions, including but not limited to monetary penalties and the striking of pleadings.

Ruling

1. For the foregoing reasons, Defendant's Motion to Proceed Anonymously is, again, **denied**.
2. Plaintiff's counsel shall prepare and e-file a proposed order conforming to this tentative ruling, attaching this tentative ruling, no later than five (5) days after the hearing.

12. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: MS5031
CASE NAME: PETITION OF: PARAQUAT CASES
HEARING IN RE: APPLICATION TO APPEAR PRO HAC VICE AS TO DEBRA R. BELOTT, ESQ.
FILED BY: CHEVRON U.S.A. INC

TENTATIVE RULING:

Summary

This tentative ruling applies to Lines 12 and 13. Defendant Chevron, et. Al ("Chevron") filed a Notice of Hearing and Motion for Debra R. Belott, Esq. and Mikayla Paolini, Esq. to be admitted as Counsel *Pro Hac Vice*. These Motions are unopposed and are **granted**. No appearance is required at the hearings on June 24, 2026.

Background

On December 31, 2025, Defendant filed Notice of Hearing, through Jones Day, on Verified Application for Admission of Debra R. Belott and Mikayla Paolini to the Bar of this Court *Pro Hac Vice* ("Motion"). The Motions were supported by verified applications and declarations. The Court did not receive timely opposition to these Motions.

Analysis

California Rules of Court (CRC) Rule 9.40 allows this Court to grant a written application for leave to appear as Counsel *Pro Hac Vice* to an applicant who is not a member of the State Bar of California, but who is admitted into and is in good standing with the highest court of any other state. Upon review, the Court finds that proposed pro hac vice counsel's applications comply CRC Rule 9.40.

After considering the moving papers, and applying the relevant law, the Court makes the following findings and orders.

Ruling

1. Defendant's motion is **granted**. Debra R. Belott, Esq. and Mikayla Paolini, Esq. to be admitted as Counsel *Pro Hac Vice* for the duration of this case.
2. Defendant's Counsel is ordered to prepare and e-file proposed orders conforming to this ruling, attaching a copy of this ruling, no later than five (5) days after the date of this hearing, and to also serve the California State Bar with these orders.
3. No appearance is required on June 24, 2026.

13. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: MS5031
CASE NAME: PETITION OF: PARAQUAT CASES
HEARING IN RE: APPLICATION TO APPEAR PRO HAC VICE AS TO MIKAYLA PAOLINI, ESQ.
FILED BY: CHEVRON U.S.A. INC.

TENTATIVE RULING:

See Line 12.